

The AI Change Agility *Flywheel.*

The gap between how organisations **currently change** and what AI-era change **demands**.
Continuous, complexity-native, behaviorally grounded.

THE CORE ARGUMENT

Every experienced change professional knows the pattern: change management is under-scoped, under-resourced, and too late.

Change Agility replaces the waterfall rollout with a continuous flywheel — seven interdependent pillars designed to run, not to finish.

THE PROBLEM

P1 Leaders assume AI adoption has an end-state. It doesn't. The technology shifts monthly. 90-day plans are obsolete by day 30.

P2 Change is treated as complicated, not complex. Define future state → plan → execute. That logic fails when the destination is unknown.

P3 Trust is ignored or assumed. Only 30% of Americans trust AI. Over half fear for their job. Change frameworks are silent on trust.

P4 Attitudes are prioritised over behavior. Awareness and desire do not produce action. Aristotle refuted this 2,400 years ago. ADKAR still hasn't caught up.

THE RESPONSE

R1 Continuous, not episodic. No GANTT charts. No steady state. The flywheel runs or it rusts. Change-agile businesses eliminate the need for change management.

R2 Complexity-native by design. Probe, sense, respond — not define, plan, execute. AI adoption lives in the complex domain (Snowden / Cynefin).

R3 Trust is measured, not assumed. Four independently variable dimensions (RIST). Under-trust and over-trust diagnosed separately. Calibration, not sentiment.

R4 Open source, not consultancy theater. Diagnostics, behavioral indicators, and tools on the Adaptive Adoption GitHub. Inspectable, improvable, free.

Seven pillars. *One flywheel.*

EACH PILLAR CARRIES A ONE-LINER AND A FAILURE MODE.

P1

Master the Craft

Building with AI is like carpentry, not calculus — you learn by building, not by passing courses.

FAIL "Training" that produces cheerleaders, not builders.

P2

Embrace Complexity

AI adoption is a complex adaptive system. You cannot workshop your way to insight — you have to experience it.

FAIL Waterfall rollouts in a complex domain.

P3

Consciously Manage Trust

RIST: four dimensions of trust, independently variable, independently diagnosable. Calibration, not vibes.

FAIL "We need to build trust" — true, unfalsifiable, changes nothing.

P4

Put People First

Augmentation before automation. You get to the efficiency gains faster by not starting with them.

FAIL Efficiency-first pilots that erode trust before they create value.

P5

Design and Prototype

Build, test, learn, iterate. The change initiative is designed with the same logic as the AI products it deploys.

FAIL A 90-day plan that is obsolete by day 30.

P6

Prioritize Behavior

Change the environment and the behaviors. The mindsets catch up. Behavioral science, not attitude change.

FAIL ADKAR: awareness → desire → knowledge → ability. Aristotle refuted this 2,400 years ago.

P7

Manage Ethics Always

Ethics is a practiced frontline capability — the guardrail that lets the bobsled go faster than would otherwise be safe.

FAIL Quarterly ethics committee reviewing incidents after the fact.